

EXCEL PROJECT - ONLINE STORE SALES ANALYSIS

Introduction

This project analyzes sales data from an online retail store. The goal was to understand how the business is performing across different products, payment methods, order statuses, and time periods. I used Excel to clean the dataset, explore the numbers, create pivot tables, build charts, and finally design an interactive dashboard. This project demonstrates my ability to work with raw transactional data and turn it into meaningful business insights.

Problem Statement

The store had several months of sales records, but the management could not clearly answer key questions such as:

- Which products generate the highest revenue?
- What months or seasons perform best?
- Who are the top customers?
- Are there any sales trends that indicate growth or decline?
- Which areas of the business need improvement?

The challenge was to turn an unorganized dataset into a structured report and visual dashboard that reveals the store's performance at a glance.

Tools Used

- Microsoft Excel
- Excel features: Data Cleaning, Sorting, Filtering, Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts, Slicers
- Excel Dashboard design (Charts, KPIs, Card Visuals)

Steps Taken

1. Data Cleaning
 - Removed blank rows and duplicates
 - Checked for missing values in key columns (Price, Quantity, Date)
 - Ensured dates were properly formatted for analysis
2. Data Transformation
 - Added new calculated columns (e.g., Total Sales = Price × Quantity)
 - Verified that the computed value matched the original
 - Converted dataset into an Excel table for easier pivoting
3. Exploratory Analysis with Pivot Tables
 - Total Sales by Product
 - Total Orders by Order Status
 - Revenue by Payment Method
 - Monthly Sales Trend
 - Sales by Referral Source

4. Visualization

Created Pivot Charts showing:

- Revenue by Month
- Top 10 Products by Sales
- Customer Contribution to Total Revenue

5. Dashboard Creation

Designed a clean Excel dashboard containing:

- KPI cards (Total Revenue, Total Units Sold, Best-Selling Product)
- Sales Trend Chart
- Best-Selling Products Bar Chart

Findings

- **Product Performance:** A few high-demand products generated most of the company's revenue. Products like Chair, Printer, Laptop, Tablet, Monitor, Desk, and Phone generated strong revenue. Chairs and printers were among the highest contributors.
- **Seasonal Trends:** Sales fluctuated over the months. Some months had noticeable peaks while others experienced a dip. This trend can help the store plan marketing campaigns around high- and low-sales months.
- **Customer Insights:** Customers mostly preferred Credit Card and Online payment, showing trust in digital payment methods.
- **Referral Source Performance:** Certain referral sources contributed more revenue than others, helping identify where marketing efforts should be focused.
- **Order Status Breakdown:** The store had a mix of order outcomes. Delivered and Shipped orders were healthy. However, Cancelled and Returned orders occurred often and may need investigation.
- **Sales Growth:** There was a visible upward trend toward the end of the period, suggesting improving sales performance.

Recommendations

- Improve logistics around cancelled and returned orders. Investigate reasons for cancellations and product return issues.
- Strengthen promotion around best-selling products Especially Chairs, Printers, and Laptops.
- Encourage digital payments further. Offer incentives like small discounts for using credit card or online payment.
- Run targeted marketing during low-sales months. This can help stabilize monthly revenue.
- Invest more in high-performing referral sources. They clearly bring in quality customers.

Dashboard Overview

